

Skills Summary

Two-Step Measurement Stories

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Time: Find the Used Minutes First

Rule: Step 1 — find the minutes already used (add them, or multiply equal rounds). Step 2 — subtract from the total time to answer the question.

Example: Art class is 50 minutes. Painting took 15 minutes, then cleanup took 10 minutes. How many minutes are left?

Step 1. The question asks for time left, but first I need the hidden number: how many minutes are already used.

Step 2. Used: $15 + 10 = 25$ minutes. Left: $50 - 25 = 25$.

Minutes left: **25** minutes

Try it: Music class is 40 minutes. Singing took 12 minutes and drums took 18 minutes. How many minutes are left?

check: 10 minutes

Money: Find the Total Cost First

Rule: Step 1 — find the total cost (add the prices, or multiply price $\times$ how many). Step 2 — subtract from the money paid to find the change.

Example: Toy cars cost 3 dollars each. Ali buys 2 cars and pays with a 10-dollar bill. How many dollars does he get back?

Step 1. Change is money paid minus cost, so the hidden first step is the total cost of the cars.

Step 2. Cost: $2 \times 3 = 6$ dollars. Change: $10 - 6 = 4$.

Ali gets back **4** dollars

Try it: Notebooks cost 4 dollars each. Min buys 2 notebooks and pays with a 10-dollar bill. How many dollars does she get back?

check: 2 dollars

Mass: Build the Load Piece by Piece

Rule: Step 1 — find the mass of the equal group (how many $\times$ mass of one). Step 2 — add or subtract the other mass. Keep every mass in the *same unit*.

Example: One bag of flour is 300 g. A basket holds 2 bags of flour and one 150 g box of sugar. What is the total mass?

Step 1. Two same-size bags make an equal group, so multiply first, then add the sugar box.

Step 2. Bags: $2 \times 300 = 600$ g. Total: $600 + 150 = 750$.

Total mass: **750** g

Try it: One can is 200 g. A shelf holds 3 cans and one 250 g box. What is the total mass?

check: 850 g

Liquid Volume: How Much Is In, How Much Is Left

Rule: Step 1 — find how much liquid went in (how many $\times$ size of each). Step 2 — subtract from the full amount to find what is still missing or left over.

Example: A tank holds 15 L when full. Ray pours in 3 buckets of 4 L each. How many liters are still needed?

Step 1. First find the hidden number — how many liters the equal buckets put in — then compare with the full tank.

Step 2. Poured in: $3 \times 4 = 12$ L. Still needed: $15 - 12 = 3$.

Still needed: **3** L

Try it: A pool tub holds 20 L when full. Jen pours in 4 buckets of 3 L each. How many liters are still needed?

check: 8 L